



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ito yāntu tapas taptuṃ gaṅgāṃ trailokyapāvanīm | BRP158.020.1
nopāyo 'nyo 'sti saṃsāre vinā gaṅgāṃ śivapriyām || 20 || BRP158.020.2
tatrāśrame puṇyadeśe jñānadaṃ pūjayiṣyatha | BRP158.021.1
sa cchedayiṣyaty akhilaṃ saṃśayaṃ vo mahāmatih | BRP158.021.2
na siddhiḥ kvāpi keṣāñcid vinā sadguruṇā yataḥ || 21 || BRP158.021.3

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 158: The Āṅgirasas and their mother's curse; Agastya's teaching (Chapter 158), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Brahmapurāṇa offers profound guidance for navigating the complexities of life and achieving spiritual liberation. The verses speak of seeking refuge in the Ganges, the river that purifies all three worlds, as the primary means to overcome the cycle of rebirth, or saṃsāra. It emphasizes that no other path holds as much promise as devotion to the Ganges, beloved of Shiva, the destroyer of illusion. This isn't merely a literal call to bathe in the river, but a symbolic invitation to immerse yourself in the cleansing flow of divine grace. The Ganges represents the purifying power of devotion, the unwavering faith that washes away impurities and doubts.

The passage then directs you towards a sacred hermitage, a place of spiritual learning, where you are to worship the giver of knowledge. This refers to a wise guru, a spiritual teacher capable of dispelling all doubts and uncertainties. The scripture asserts that without a true guru, spiritual success remains elusive. The guru acts as a guide, leading you through the labyrinth of your own mind and helping you to realize your true potential.

In today's world, where we are bombarded with information and conflicting opinions, the need for such guidance is more crucial than ever. The 'Ganges' can be interpreted as seeking out practices that purify your mind, like meditation, selfless service, or spending time in nature. The 'guru' can be anyone who embodies wisdom and compassion – a teacher, a mentor, or even a book that resonates deeply with your soul. The core message is to actively seek out sources of purification and guidance, acknowledging that true progress requires humility and a willingness to learn from those who have walked the path before you. By embracing this wisdom, you can navigate the challenges of modern life with greater clarity, purpose, and inner peace.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you actively seeking out sources of purification and guidance in your life, and are you truly open to receiving the wisdom they offer?